

AI Calling Strategy for Ditto Insurance

PM Intern Case Study

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Ditto's constraint is not the quality of the advice; it is the difference between the lead's intention and the adviser's dialogue. This below report outlines an extremely narrow scope for an AI calling layer to recover no-shows and activate dormant leads without interfering with the human advisory process.

Section A: Sales Funnel & Opportunity

Ditto's Funnel

Ditto is inbound-only: leads self-select via joinditto.in, book a free 30-min call with an IRDAI-certified advisor, and receive 2-3 curated policy recommendations. No cold calls, no agent push. The funnel below maps this model with conversion estimates calibrated from InsurTech benchmarks (Unbounce 2024, B2B SaaS Funnel Report 2025, IndiaInsurTech 2024).

Stage	What Happens	Conv. Rate	AI Fit?
Awareness	Finshots newsletter (500K+), SEO, referrals	-	-
Lead Capture	Form fill: name, phone, insurance type	5-8% visitors	-
Slot Booking	Leads book a 30-min advisory call	45-55% of leads	Secondary
Pre-Call	WhatsApp/email confirmation + reminder	~95%	-
Call Attendance	Lead shows up for scheduled call	65-72% of bookings	Primary
Advisory Call	Needs assessment, 2-3 recs, Q&A. Human only.	~80% → proposal	Never AI
Follow-up	Proposals shared on WhatsApp, lead compares	35-45% engage	Secondary
Application	Policy selected, forms + docs submitted	28-35%	-

Where AI Should Intervene (Ranked)

Priority 1: No-Show Recovery (Stage 5)

28-35% of booked calls go unattended. At 100 leads, that's ~15-19 warm, self-qualified prospects who never meet an advisor. Recovering even 40% of them adds ~6-8 extra consultations per 100 leads - direct revenue.

Why AI is the right tool here:

- The task is bounded: a single question - 'You missed your call. Can we reschedule?' - with no judgment, no policy complexity, and no sales pressure.
- No advisor time is wasted chasing no-shows manually.
- Brand risk is negligible: the call is a service action (rescheduling), not a sales call.
- Measurable within two weeks of pilot launch.

Priority 2: Lead Activation (Stage 3)

Leads who fill the form but don't book within 48 hrs. AI confirms their intent and offers time slots. It routes to a human - never advises.

Priority 3 (Future): Post-Consult Re-engagement (Stage 7)

Leads who went silent after receiving proposals. Higher conversational complexity; deploy only after the pilot persona is stable. Premature here risks feeling like a sales push.

The advisory call itself (Stage 6) must remain 100% human. That call is Ditto's product. Automating it would trade brand trust for marginal cost savings.

Section B: Platform Research & Comparison

Three platforms evaluated via public pricing, documentation, and direct outreach. Criteria weighted for Ditto: India compliance (TRAI/IRDAI), Hindi/Hinglish quality, total cost, data sovereignty, setup speed.

Criterion	Plivo	Retell AI	Sarvam AI ★
Pricing/min	~\$0.05 AI agent layer + separate LLM/TTS. Infra from \$0.004/min.	\$0.13-0.31/min all-in. Enterprise: ~\$0.05 base, \$1.2-1.8K/mo for 10K min.	₹1/min (~\$0.012) - price is dynamic. 10-25× cheaper than Retell.
Hindi/Indic	Via ElevenLabs integration. Not native Indian.	30+ langs, manual config. No native Hinglish code-switching.	Native Hindi + 10 Indian langs. Handles Hinglish code-switching. Indian accent default.
India Compliance	DLT-registered, local numbers, TRAI-compliant infra.	Not India-native. Data may exit India - IRDAI risk. No DLT pre-registration.	India-built, sovereign data. IRDAI-favorable. Tata Capital already uses it.
CRM / API	REST API, webhooks. No-code Vibe Builder.	Make/n8n/Zapier, REST API. Strong dev tooling.	REST API, webhooks. Composable - can pair with custom LLM.
Latency	<500ms. 99.99% uptime.	700-800ms (independent tests).	Sub-second for Indian voice. India hosting = lower RTT.
Limitation	AI agent + LLM + TTS costs are additive.	Expensive for India. Data sovereignty gap.	Newer platform, smaller global community.

Recommendation: Sarvam AI + Plivo Telephony

Sarvam Samvaad handles the conversational AI (STT, LLM, TTS). Plivo provides India-DLT-registered numbers as the telephony carrier. This hybrid gives Ditto the best of both:

- Native Hinglish code-switching - Ditto’s customers are bilingual; Sarvam’s Bulbul v3 handles this natively, unlike global platforms.
- Cost: ₹1/min saves ₹90K-1.25L/month vs Retell on a 500-call/day pilot.
- IRDAI compliance: insurance call recordings stored in India. Retell’s US-cloud default is a liability, not a theoretical concern.
- Plivo’s DLT infra removes the regulatory setup burden for telephony.

Section C: AI Caller Design

Q3: Persona - Diya

Name	Diya (Sanskrit: ‘light’ - warmth + guidance; echoes ‘Ditto’)
Role	AI scheduling assistant. Gets customers to a human advisor. Never gives policy advice.
Personality	Unhurried, helpful, transparent. Speaks like a colleague, not a telemarketer. Comfortable in Hinglish. Always honest about being AI.
Voice	Warm, moderate pace, Indian-accented English. Sarvam ‘Priya’ or ‘Neha’ voice profile.
AI Disclosure	Introduces herself as ‘an AI assistant from Ditto’ in every call opener. Confirms immediately if asked. TRAI + brand mandate.

Call Script - No-Show Recovery (~45 sec)

Trigger: 30 min after a missed scheduled call.

Diya:	"Hi, am I speaking with [First Name]?"
[If yes]	
Diya:	"This is Diya, an AI assistant from Ditto Insurance. You had a consultation call scheduled earlier today and we missed connecting. No problem - would you like to reschedule?"

[Yes]

Diya: "Great - would 5 PM or 7 PM today work, or would tomorrow be better?"

[Time given]

Diya: "Noted. You'll get a WhatsApp confirmation soon. Anything specific you want the advisor to focus on - health insurance, term life, or something else?"

[Response]

Diya: "Perfect. Our advisor will call you at [time]. Have a great day!"

Q4: Edge Cases

Customer Behaviour

Edge Case	Handling
"I'm busy"	"No problem, later today or tomorrow?" If declined 2x → suppress 6 hrs, WhatsApp follow-up.
Already spoke to someone	Confirm, update CRM, suppress all AI calls for this lead.
Not interested	Respect immediately. Log opt-out. Remove from all AI + marketing queues. No further contact without fresh consent.
Asked Policy question	Dont answer. "Our advisors are best placed for that - can I book a call?" Route to human advisor.
Angry / bad words / frustated	Acknowledge. "I'll make sure our team knows. We won't call again without your permission." mark as NEGATIVE.
"Are you bot?"	Honestly tell: "Yes, I'm Diya, an AI assistant from Ditto." Stay in character, offer to book a human call.

Technical Failures

Failure	Handling
No answer / voicemail	Leave 1 voicemail (<20 sec): name, reason, callback number. No repeat voicemail same session.
Call drops	Silence >10s → auto-end. Preserve transcript. Trigger WhatsApp: "Sorry, we got disconnected - want to reschedule?"
STT can't understand	After 2 failed attempts: "Let me connect you via WhatsApp." End gracefully. Log as STT_FAILED.
Platform outage	>5% failure rate in 15 min → pause campaign, alert ops. Auto-retry failed calls 1× with 30-min backoff.

Language & Escalation

Scenario	Handling
Switches to Hindi	Sarvam auto-switches. No disruption.
Unsupported regional language	"Let me connect you with our team in your language." Route to WhatsApp with language flag.
DND-registered number	Do not call. DNC scrub before every campaign. WhatsApp-only follow-up.
Outside 9 AM-9 PM IST	Hard block. Auto-queue for 9 AM next day. TRAI - no exceptions.
Requests human advisor	"Of course!" Offer time slot. If urgent: "Our team will call within 30 min." Log escalation.
Mentions a claim/complaint	Out of scope. Route to claims team number/WhatsApp immediately.

Scenario	Handling
"Remove me from calling"	Immediate opt-out. WhatsApp confirmation in 2 min. Suppressed permanently. Timestamped for audit.

Section D: Execution Plan

Q5: Idea to Deployment (~10 Weeks)

Phase 0 - Foundations (Wk 1-2)

- **Legal:** Register on DLT portal: calling header, SMS/WhatsApp templates, 140-series number. TRAI compliance is Day 0.
- **Compliance:** IRDAI review: confirm AI scheduling calls fall within broking licence scope. Confirm 6-month call recording retention.
- **Engineering:** Tag every CRM lead with consent timestamp, DND flag, insurance type, assigned advisor.
- **Vendor:** Sarvam AI contract + KYC. Configure Plivo DLT numbers as telephony layer. E2E call test.

Phase 1 - Script Design (Wk 2-3)

- Interview 5-8 Ditto advisors on how they handle reschedule calls. Capture real phrasing and objections.
- Build script in 3 variants (Hindi, English, Hinglish). Test with advisors role-playing as customers. Iterate until Diya sounds like Ditto.
- Define branching logic, 90-sec hard cap, fallback triggers, WhatsApp template library.

Phase 2 - Integration (Wk 3-4)

- Sarvam API ↔ CRM webhook: lead record in, call outcome out.
- DNC scrubbing pipeline: nightly NCPR pull, pre-campaign scrub.
- Calling window enforcement: 9 AM-9 PM IST hard lock. Recording storage: India-hosted, 6-month retention.
- Operations dashboard live (see Section E).

Phase 3 - Controlled Pilot (Wk 5-6)

- 200 no-show leads over 2 weeks. Single use case only.
- A/B test: 50% get Diya's call + WhatsApp, 50% get WhatsApp only (control).
- Daily transcript review by one ops member. Flag any off-script behaviour.
- No-go criteria: opt-out >8%, TRAI violation flagged, or brand complaint → pause immediately.

Phase 4 - Iterate & Expand (Wk 7+)

- Analyse pilot: contact rate, reschedule rate, post-reschedule attendance, sentiment. Refine top 3 failure modes.
- If A/B shows >15% improvement in attendance → expand to full no-show volume.
- Activate Priority 2 (lead activation). Evaluate Priority 3 only once pilot persona is proven.

Q6: Data Formats

Input - Lead Record (CRM → AI System)

Field	Type	Description
lead_id	string	Unique ID. e.g., DTT-20250412-4821
first_name	string	For personalised greeting
phone_number	string	+91XXXXXXXXXX (E.164), DNC pre-scrubbed
consent_timestamp	ISO 8601	When consent was captured
insurance_type_interest	enum	HEALTH TERM BOTH UNKNOWN
call_trigger	enum	NO_SHOW LEAD_ACTIVATION POST_CONSULT
scheduled_slot_time	ISO 8601	Original booked slot (for no-show context)
preferred_language	enum	EN HI HINGLISH DETECT (default: DETECT)

Field	Type	Description
dnc_status	boolean	true = DNC, do not call
ai_call_attempts	int	Prior attempts. Hard cap: 2 per trigger.

Output - Call Result (AI System → CRM)

Field	Type	Description
call_id	string	Unique session ID
call_duration_seconds	int	Connected call duration
call_outcome	enum	RESCHEDULED NO_ANSWER VOICEMAIL OPTED_OUT ALREADY_CONNECTED ESCALATED STT_FAILED DROPPED
reschedule_slot	ISO 8601	New slot if RESCHEDULED, else null
sentiment_flag	enum	POSITIVE NEUTRAL NEGATIVE CRITICAL
language_used	enum	EN HI HINGLISH REGIONAL
transcript_url	string	Secure link to recording + transcript (6-month retention)
edge_case_flags	array	e.g., [POLICY_QUESTION, LANGUAGE_SWITCH_HI]
next_action	enum	WHATSAPP_FOLLOWUP HUMAN_CALL SUPPRESS RETRY_IN_6H

Q7: KPIs

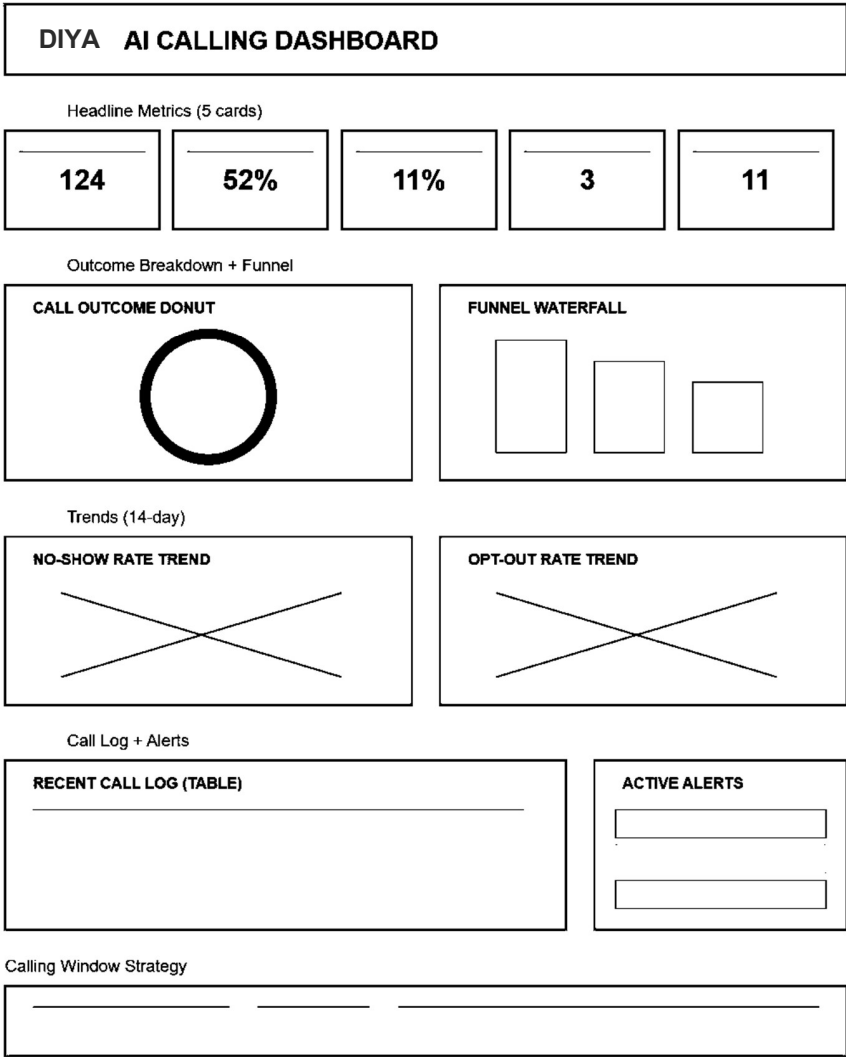
KPI	Target (Pilot)	Why It Matters
No-Show Recovery Rate	>30% rescheduled	Primary impact metric. Directly measures value recovered from a proven funnel leak.
Contact Rate	>55% connected	Call timing + number quality signal. Below 40% = wrong window, bad data, or DNC issues.
Opt-Out Rate	<5% per run	Brand health. Above 8% = Diya is perceived as spam. Immediate script review trigger.
Reschedule → Attendance	>70% attended	Validates that AI-rescheduled slots actually convert. Low = reschedule itself is broken.
Human Escalation Rate	<10%	Script coverage check. Too high = missing scenarios. Too low = failing to route valid escalations.

Secondary metric (from week 4): Cost per Rescheduled Consultation. Target: under ₹40.

Section E: Sales Manager Dashboard

Diya Control - Daily Operations View

Purpose: single screen to track AI calling performance, catch problems early, and surface coaching opportunities.



Row 3 - Trends (14-day)

No-Show Rate: Before vs After AI (Line Chart) Two lines: raw no-show rate vs effective rate after recovery. Gap = AI’s direct contribution.	Opt-Out Rate Trend (Bar) Daily opt-out % with 5% red threshold line. Spike = immediate investigation.
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Row 4 - Call Log + Alerts

Recent Call Log (Scrollable Table) Columns: Time Name Duration Outcome Sentiment Transcript. Color-coded: green=rescheduled, yellow=voicemail, red=opted out.	Active Alerts Auto-fires when: opt-out >5%, escalation queue >3, contact rate drops >15% from avg, API errors >5%, call outside 9AM-9PM. Each: severity + trigger + action.
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Calling Window Strategy

Window	Priority	Why
11 AM - 1 PM IST	HIGH	Post-morning, pre-lunch. Highest answer rate for salaried 25-40 demo.
5 - 8 PM IST	HIGH	Post-work. Customer available for personal finance tasks.
9 - 11 AM IST	MEDIUM	Valid but lower pickup - commute/standup time.
Before 9 AM / After 9 PM	BLOCKED	TRAI restriction. Hard system lock.

Sources

Sources: joinditto.in, Zerodha Z-Connect blog (Feb 2024), Freshteam job listing, Medium teardown (Gorang, Mar 2025). Platform pricing: Plivo India voice pricing page, Sarvam AI API pricing, Retell AI pricing via Synthflow/Ringg comparisons. Benchmarks: Unbounce Finance/Insurance Conversion Report 2024, B2B SaaS Funnel Benchmarks 2025 (thedigitalbloom.com), IndiaInsurTech Data-Driven Evolution 2024. Compliance: rootle.ai (TRAI/IRDAI/DPDPA guide), TRAI TCCCPR regulations, conversailabs.com DND compliance guide.